

SWING BETTER, SWING HARDER

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #181

Notes and rhythms (the “WHAT” part of music) are very important, but the “HOW” part is where the feel and the soul comes from. No matter what your ability level, you of course want to swing harder and better. Here are three important HOW’s you need to get into your practice.

- 1) Play legato. Like, really really legato.
- 2) Put your metronome on 2 & 4. Not on all four beats, not on 1 & 3.
- 3) Practice straight, random 8th notes for five minutes a day. No rests.

These items sound simple, and they are. But they aren’t easy. Nine out of ten of us will need a coach to help us be successful with these HOW’s. Hint: you may not be that one out of ten! Get some help from a great teacher, and progress like crazy! JazzWire.net can help.

#1 - A “Bird-like” line



Some Notes:

- In these eight measures, there are only THREE places where there is a break between pitches. Those are the three 8th rests. Legato!
- Have your foot tapping on beats 2 & 4, and be *feeling* 2 & 4.
- This is swing, but this should be played with a pretty “straight” feel. Don’t overdo the swing feel, when playing above mm = 140 or so.

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